soon after Plassey, the Bengal plunder began to arrive in London,

** 'Rise and Fulfilment of British Rule in India' by Edward Thompson and G. T. Garrett*

*(London, 1935).*



and the effect appears to have been instantaneous, for all authorities agree that the "industrial revolution" began with the year 1 7 7 0 . . . . Plassey was fought in 1757, and probably nothing has ever equalled the rapidity of the change that followed. In 1760 the flying shuttle appeared, and coal began to replace wood in smelting. In 1764 Hargreaves invented the spinning jenny, in 1776 Grompton contrived the mule, in 1785 Cartwright patented the power loom and in 1768 Watt matured the steam e n g i n e . . . . But though these machines served as outlets for the accelerating movements of the time, they did not cause the acceleration. In themselves inventions are passive.. . waiting for a sufficient store of force to have accumulated to set them working. That store must always take the shape of money, and money not hoarded but in motion. Before the influx of the Indian treasure, and the expansion of credit which followed, no force sufficient for this purpose existed.... Possibly since the world began, no investment has ever yielded the